2. Maintain just and honourable relations between nations.
3. Foster respect for international law and treaty obligations in the dealings of organized peoples with one another.
4. Encourage settlement of international disputes by arbitration.

In Britain, the customary rules of international law are deemed to be part of the law of the land and are applied by the British municipal courts with certain qualifications. The rules must not be inconsistent with the British statute and that once the scope of such customary rules has been decided by the British courts of final authority, all British courts are thereafter bound by that decision even though a divergent customary rule of international law later develops. As far as treaties are concerned, the negotiation, signature and ratification of treaties are matters belonging to the prerogative powers of the Crown and the legislative domain of the Parliament.

The American practice relating to customary rules of international law is very similar to the British practice. Such rules are administered as part of the law of the land. Regarding treaties, the American practice rests upon the provisions of the US Constitution stipulating that “all Treaties made, or which shall be made under the Authority of the United States”, shall be “the supreme Law of the Land” (Article VI, para 2).

However, it has also been pointed out by experts on international law that if international law draws its validity from a state constitution, it will cease to be in force once the constitution on which its authority rests, disappears. The operation of international law has proven that it is independent of change or abolition of constitutions. The London Conference of 1831 upheld that “treaties do not lose their force despite internal constitutional changes”. Even the entry of new states into the international society binds the new states with international law without its consent and such consent, even if it is expressed is merely declaratory of the true legal position. The dismemberment of the erstwhile Soviet Union and the emergence of new states did not end the Soviet Union’s Treaty obligations with other states, and the newly independent states could not make themselves insulated from international law. Above all, it is the duty of every state to bring not only its laws but also its constitution into harmony with international